FBL • CHAPTER OPERATIONS GUIDE

Chapter Operations Guide

This guide defines how FBL chapters operate consistently across markets. Chapters may customize local logistics (venue, timing), but may not alter FBL purpose, brand, culture, or nonprofit boundaries.

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START HERE PURPOSE MEETINGS ROLES ONBOARDING COMMUNICATIONS DATA ESCALATION

Non-negotiables: no politics, no lobbying, no pitch culture, no misuse of member data, no brand deviations.

Start Here: Operating Standard

A chapter is successful when it consistently produces a trusted room: respectful, high-signal conversation, and practical leverage. The leader's job is to protect the environment—not chase volume.

Protect the Room

- Time discipline
- No pitch behavior
- Respectful conversation
- Privacy & discretion

What "Good" Looks Like

- Members want to return
- Low drama / high trust
- Organic collaboration
- Clear leadership presence

- [ ] I understand my primary job is to protect the room and the culture—not to build a transactional group.
- [ ] I understand FBL is not a referral club and does not guarantee referrals, deals, or ROI.

1. Purpose & Positioning

FBL is a leadership community for operators. Chapters exist to develop trust, perspective, and strategic introductions—without pressure.

FBL Is

- Leadership-focused community
- Trusted peer room
- Practical leverage through relationship

FBL Is Not

- Pitch night
- Lead swap
- Political platform

- [ ] I will position FBL correctly and will not market meetings as a referral exchange or sales forum.
- [ ] I will protect nonprofit boundaries: no political endorsements, campaigning, or lobbying under FBL.

2. Meetings: Cadence, Format, Standards

Chapters may choose a meeting cadence and venue, but the meeting must remain structured, time-disciplined, and leadership-centered.

Minimum Standards

- Start/end on time
- Clear agenda
- Facilitated discussion
- No pitch behavior

Suggested Flow

- Welcome (2–3 min)
- Member updates (high-level)
- Leadership topic discussion
- Strategic introductions (earned)
- Close + next date

- [ ] I will enforce a no-pitch environment and intervene when behavior becomes transactional.

- [ ] I will keep meetings structured and time-respectful.

3. Chapter Roles & Continuity

Leadership continuity protects members. Chapters should identify backup leadership and delegate basic operations where possible.

Recommended Roles

- **Chapter Leader**: culture, compliance, execution
- **Co-Lead**: backup + continuity
- **Admin**: logistics + reminders

Leader Responsibilities

- Protect standards
- Onboard members correctly
- Escalate issues early
- Represent FBL professionally

- [ ] I will maintain continuity coverage (co-lead or interim plan) and not leave the chapter leaderless.

- [ ] I understand central leadership has final authority over chapter leadership assignments.

4. Member Onboarding & Standards

The goal is alignment, not volume. Members must understand expectations up front: no pitch, respect time, protect privacy.

Onboarding Essentials

- Set expectations clearly
- Confirm culture fit
- Introduce Code of Conduct
- Make the room feel safe

Avoid

- Pressure recruiting
- Overpromising value
- Quotas or forced behavior
- Transactional language

- [ ] I will onboard members with clear expectations and enforce standards consistently.
- [ ] I will not promise referrals or use pressure tactics to grow the chapter.

5. Communications & Public Representation

Communications should be professional, brief, and aligned. No political content, no controversy, no misrepresentation.

Do

- Send clear meeting info
- Set expectations
- Keep tone calm and professional

Don’t

- Claim partnerships without approval
- Post politics under FBL identity
- Use hype/pressure language

- [ ] I will represent FBL professionally in communications and social media.
- [ ] I will escalate media/press requests and will not speak as an official FBL

representative without approval.

6. Member Data, Privacy & Solicitation

Member lists are not sales assets. Data misuse is a trust violation and may trigger removal.

- [ ] I will not export, sell, share, or use member contact info for solicitation or non-FBL purposes.
- [ ] I will report any data misuse or privacy concern immediately to central leadership.

7. Escalation, Incidents & Enforcement

If it risks compliance, reputation, money, or member trust—escalate first. Silence creates risk.

Escalate Immediately

- Political / lobbying behavior
- Financial misuse concerns
- Harassment, threats, unsafe behavior
- Public reputational incidents

Escalate Before Acting

- Member removal decisions
- Public statements
- Partnership claims
- Any unclear boundary

- [ ] I will escalate compliance, legal, financial, or reputational issues immediately.
- [ ] I understand enforcement protects the room and is part of leadership responsibility.

Rule: If you're unsure, escalate. Don't improvise.

Acknowledgment

By signing below, I acknowledge I have read and agree to follow the FBL Chapter Operations Guide.

CHAPTER NAME

e.g., FBL – Greater Louisville

ROLE

e.g., Chapter Leader, Co-Lead, Region

NAME / SIGNATURE

Type full name

DATE

04/22/2026

NOTES (OPTIONAL)

Optional notes...

Submission: Use the email button to submit this acknowledgment to FBL for recordkeeping.The Email button will activate once all required acknowledgments are checked, a membership payment option is selected, and the sign-off fields are completed. If the button appears inactive, click into the date field to confirm today's date or select a different date. Once all requirements are satisfied, the button will turn blue.

Operating Standard: Consistency protects the mission and scales the model.

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Fellowship of Business Leaders

FBL exists for leaders who already lead.

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WHY BECOME A MEMBER

CODE OF CONDUCT

COMPANY

EVENTS

HISTORY

CHAPTERS

CHAPTER PACKET

BRAND KIT

CHAPTER OPERATIONS GUIDE

ON-BOARDING CHECKLIST

FINACIAL STEWARDSHIP POLICY

BRAND LEADERSHIP ENFORCEMENT

LEADERSHIP AGREEMENT

COMMUNICATION & MEDIA POLICY

LAUNCH SCORECARD

CONFLICT OF INTEREST

REMOVAL & SUCCESSION POLICY

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